Sliders

Sliders let users make selections from a range of values

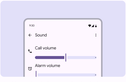
Resources: Figma, Web, iOS, Android

Sliders can adjust values in real time, such as image attributes

Usage

Sliders are used to select values along a track. They're ideal for adjusting settings such as volume or brightness, or changing the intensity of image filters.

Sliders can use icons or labels to represent a numeric or relative scale.



Use sliders to pick a value from a range, like volume loudness

Changes made with sliders must take effect immediately, so people can understand the effects of their selection as they're moving the slider.

Selection changes are immediate

There are three different variants of sliders: **standard**, **centered**, and **range**.

Standard sliders select one value from a range of values. Use this when defining a starting point or the beginning of a sequence.

Horizontal standard slider

Vertical standard slider

Centered sliders select a value from a positive and negative value range. Use this when zero, or the default value, is in the middle of the range.

Horizontal centered slider

Vertical centered slider

Range sliders select two values on one slider to create a range. Use this when defining a minimum and maximum value.

Avoid using range sliders vertically, as this can add too much cognitive load. Instead, opt for most sliders being horizontal.

Horizontal range slider

Because of the additional cognitive load of a range slider, avoid using it in vertical orientation.

Anatomy

1. Value indicator (optional)
2. Step indicators (optional)
3. Active track
4. Handle
5. Inactive track
6. Inset icon (optional)

Track

The track shows the full range of values that can be selected on the slider. It has two sections: active and inactive.

- The **active** section of the track shows the selected values. We handle, for range sliders, the active track is between the two handles.
- The **inactive** section of the track is from the handle to the maximum value, or outside the two handles of a range slider.

For left-to-right (LTR) languages, the values increase from left to right. For rights to left (RTL) languages, this is reversed.

The track on a slider shows the available range

Handle

The handle can be moved along the track to choose a value.

When sliders have two handles, the handles choose the minimum and maximum values in a range.

The handle changes shape to indicate when it's pressed.

A handle changes shape when it's being pressed or dragged

Two handles are used for sliders with range selection

Configurations

Value

The value displays the specific value that corresponds with the handle's placement.

A value appears when interacting with the corresponding handle. For range sliders, only one value should be shown at a time.

A value can appear while the handle is being pressed or dragged

For range sliders, the value only appears on one handle at a time

If the value is shown elsewhere, the indicator is not required.

Instead of showing the built-in value label, a separate text input field can be added outside of the slider. This can be helpful when and value in this text field should automatically update to match each other.

Make sure people can talk to the text field directly after the slider.

Use **Tab** to navigate to values that are shown outside the slider, like a text input field

Step indicators

Step indicators show which predetermined values can be chosen on the slider. The slider snaps to the closest step.

Avoid having too many step indicators on a slider, because it can become visually crowded and difficult to adjust the value.

Step indicators show each available value on a slider

All sliders have steps at the end of the inactive track to ensure at least a 3:1 contrast with the background. If the inactive track is too low contrast already, the end steps can be removed.

Icons or text can be added outside the slider to indicate the range of values and make the slider more accessible. This can be used instead of a step indicator.

Plus and minus icons, or text, can be added to the left and right of the slider

Orientation

Sliders can be oriented either horizontally or vertically, depending on what is best for your use case.

Standard slider in horizontal orientation

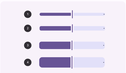
Standard slider in vertical orientation

Inset icon

Standard sliders that are M, L, or XL can include an icon within the track. This can be used to represent what the slider controls. Avoid adding inset icons to XS or S sliders.

When there's not enough space for the icon on the active track, like on a low value, the icon moves to the inactive track.

Consider swapping which icon is displayed at zero, like a volume icon becoming a mute icon.



Inset icons change placement based on the handle

Don't use an inset icon with sliders that have track thicknesses under 40dp

Don't use inset icons on centered or range sliders. It makes it unclear where the start of the slider is.

Don't use an inset icon on a centered slider

Don't use an inset icon on a range slider

Size

Sliders come in different sizes: XS, S, M, L, and XL. Use larger sizes to increase the targets and provide a larger visual emphasis.

The active and inactive tracks should always be the same size.

1. XS: 16dp
2. S: 24dp
3. M: 40dp
4. L: 56dp
5. XL: 96dp

XL sliders should be reserved for important actions, where the slider itself is the most important element on the page.

XL sliders should be the focus of the page

Behaviors

Select & drag

Select a value by dragging the handle.

Standard slider: The handle drags smoothly

Slider with step indicators: The handle snaps to the closest step indicator while dragged

Select jump

Select a value by selecting part of the track.

Standard slider: The handle moves to the selected location

Slider with step indicators: The handle moves to the closest step indicator

Select & arrow

Select a value using the keyboard.

Tab: Focus lands on handle

Arrows: Selected value increases or decreases by one value or step indicator

Space & arrows: Selected value increases or decreases by a larger interval or step indicator

Standard slider: The handle moves one value

Slider with step indicators: The handle moves to the next step indicator